

THE DAILY PUNT

ISSUE
#1

★ ★ ★ ★ — PUNTESLIGA • INAUGURAL EDITION • AUGUST 2026 — ★ ★

HERBERT SWINGS NORTH

Seattle pays big to land its franchise QB

BO KNOWS DENVER

Browncocks take Bo Nix in Round 2

OILERS vs GAMBLERS

The first beef of the year has already kicked off 

ALSO INSIDE

- Rookie Jets owner makes noise
- Chuggers build another monster
- The battle for Washington begins
- Real NFL news, rookie watch & preseason updates



WHO'S SET UP BEST FOR DOMINANCE?

TEN FRANCHISES. ONE STARTUP DRAFT. A THOUSAND BAD DECISIONS.



POWER RANKINGS COMING NEXT ISSUE

BIGGEST REACHES & STEALS

TRADE GRADES

OWNER HOT SEAT





★ ALL THE MOVES.
★ ALL THE STORYLINES.
★ ALL THE CHAOS.

STARTUP DRAFT LEAVES TEN VERY DIFFERENT FRANCHISES BEHIND

The inaugural Puntesliga Startup Draft is in the books.

Ten franchises entered with the same amount of draft capital. What they did with it is another matter entirely.

Some built for today. Some built for tomorrow. Some chased upside. Some chased their favourite NFL team.

And one team auto-drafted a kicker in Round 11.

Welcome to the Puntesliga.



SWINGERS BET THE HOUSE ON HERBERT

Seattle has its quarterback.

The Swingers acquired Justin Herbert from the San Diego Chuggers, sending Emeka Egbuka, Jayden Price and a 2027 second-round pick the other way.

It's an enormous commitment — but perhaps the most predictable blockbuster of the draft.

Josh is a Chargers fan. Herbert is a Charger. Seattle needed a cornerstone quarterback.

The only surprise is that Josh still had draft capital left when negotiations began.

According to sources close to the organization, Herbert's brief stay in San Diego simply wasn't working out. His soon-to-be wife Madison Beer reportedly wasn't sold on the destination, and Herbert began looking elsewhere.

Then Seattle called.

The Swingers didn't ask what it would cost. They asked where to sign.



THE DAILY PUNT TRADE GRADE	
 SEATTLE SWINGERS B Herbert gives Seattle exactly what a Superflex dynasty roster needs: a premium quarterback who can anchor the franchise for years. The price, however, was enormous.	 SAN DIEGO CHUGGERS A Ben turned one elite asset into multiple pieces without compromising an already strong roster. Annoyingly competent.

PURDY CHANGES PLANES

Another major deal saw Brock Purdy and Tyler Warren land with Ruben's New York Jets, while TreyVeon Henderson and Ladd McConkey joined Julian's Hollywood Oilers.

For the Jets, it's an aggressive move from an owner participating in his first serious fantasy-football league.

And that's becoming a theme.

Ruben entered the Puntesliga as one of its biggest unknowns. Instead of looking overwhelmed, the rookie has largely drafted like someone who belongs here.

There is just one potential weakness.

Meme players.

Put George Pickens highlights in front of this man and rational roster construction can disappear remarkably quickly.

Cam Skattebo exists.

Therefore, Ruben is always in danger.

NEW YORK
JETS
B. PURDY
T. WARREN

HOLLYWOOD
OILERS
T. HENDERSON
L. MCCONKEY



THE DENVER CIVIL WAR

There are four things you need to know about David and Michi.

- ★ They're brothers.
- ★ They're German.
- ★ They both love the Denver Broncos.
- ★ And neither particularly enjoys watching the other draft Broncos players.

That has created perhaps the Puntesliga's most natural rivalry.

Michi's Denver Browncocks made the loudest declaration of loyalty by selecting Bo Nix in Round 2.

BO NIX
ROUND 2



Was it early?
Yes.

Does Michi care?
Absolutely not.

Nix now arrives at the Browncocks' famous rooster farm as the face of the franchise.

Meanwhile, David's Washington Foreskins have repeatedly shown a willingness to jump ahead of Denver when another Broncos player appears on the board.



Forget Washington versus Denver. This is brother versus brother.

And there are still years of rookie drafts ahead.

SAME BLOOD.
DIFFERENT DRAFT BOARD.

AUBREY-GATE

Every great franchise has an origin story.

The Washington Foreskins have Round 11.

David's draft room watched helplessly as the clock expired and the computer made its selection:

Brandon Aubrey.

A kicker.

In a dynasty startup.
Round 11.

The organization insists it was an auto-draft malfunction.

The history books will simply record that David drafted Brandon Aubrey.



“THE CLOCK EXPIRED. THE AUTO-DRAFT WAS MERCILESS.”

AROUND THE LEAGUE



SAN DIEGO — The Chuggers continue to operate with the irritating stability expected from veteran owner and co-commissioner Ben. Cold beverages remain available throughout team facilities.



BOSTON — Nils has quietly gone about his business while louder owners dominate the headlines. The Tea Bags may prefer it that way.



TITSBURGH — Andy's Feelers remain one of the more difficult teams to evaluate. The experienced German owner rarely lets Broncos fandom interfere with roster construction and appears content to feel out the competition.



GREEN BAY — Kyle has embraced risk from Day One. The Gamblers are appropriately named.



WASHINGTON — Kye's Commando entered the post-draft landscape near the bottom of early projections. The Canadian owner remains unfailingly polite about it. Frankly, it's unsettling.

FROM THE COMMISSIONER'S OFFICE

An exclusive interview with Oilers owner, Punteliga Commissioner and Daily Punt CEO Julian

DAILY PUNT: Some owners have raised concerns that owning the league's primary newspaper represents a conflict of interest.

JULIAN: I haven't heard those concerns.

DAILY PUNT: Kyle has raised them.

JULIAN: I said I haven't heard those concerns.

DAILY PUNT: Speaking of Kyle, how would you describe the Oilers-Gamblers relationship?

JULIAN: Healthy competition.

DAILY PUNT: Kyle called you out in the group chat.

JULIAN: Green Bay is currently under investigation for tampering.

DAILY PUNT: By whom?

JULIAN: Next question.

DAILY PUNT: Drake Maye?

JULIAN: Greatest quarterback of all time.

DAILY PUNT: He's 23.

JULIAN: And already accomplished more than Kyle.



THE PUNT NOTEBOOK



WHILE WE WERE DRAFTING...

The Punteliga may have spent the week arguing about startup value, but the NFL has entered the part of August where dynasty managers begin dramatically overreacting to every preseason snap.

And we wouldn't have it any other way.



PRESEASON WEEK 2 ARRIVES

The NFL's second preseason weekend runs August 20-23, meaning another slate of games arrives just as dynasty managers begin looking for evidence that their summer takes were correct.

For the Punteliga, these games offer the first real opportunity to watch newly drafted assets with the added emotional investment that only dynasty ownership can provide.

One impressive drive? Future superstar. Two bad series? Sell immediately.

Welcome back, football.



ROOKIE WATCH IS OFFICIALLY OPEN

NFL.com's preseason coverage has already begun highlighting rookies making early impressions, including Rams rookie quarterback Ty Simpson, who drew praise following his preseason debut.

That's exactly the kind of August development dynasty managers should notice — without immediately rewriting three years of prospect evaluation because somebody completed passes against a second-team defense.

Of course, somebody in the Punteliga will do exactly that.

Our money is on Ruben.



JOBS ARE STILL UP FOR GRABS

Training camp has also brought significant position battles across the NFL, with starting jobs and depth-chart roles still being decided around the league.

For redraft players, that's interesting.

For dynasty managers with 28-man rosters, it means spending an unreasonable amount of time researching whether a 22-year-old third-string receiver received two first-team reps on Wednesday.

Civilization has peaked.

THE DAILY PUNT OWNER HOT SEAT

Who already has something to prove?



KYE — WASHINGTON COMMANDO

Someone had to finish last in the first set of power rankings. Congratulations, Kye.

The Commando's aggressive approach created a roster with plenty of variance, but early projections have Washington looking upward at the rest of the league.

The good news? There is nowhere better to begin an underdog story.

PRESSURE LEVEL



MICHI — DENVER BROWNCOCKS

Nobody will question whether Michi believes in his players. They may question whether he believes in players who aren't Denver Broncos.

Bo Nix in Round 2 planted the flag.

Now it needs to work.

PRESSURE LEVEL



JOSH — SEATTLE SWINGERS

Trading for Justin Herbert transformed Seattle's roster. It also removed the luxury of patience.

When you pay that much for a quarterback, nobody remembers the price if you win. If you lose? The Daily Punt keeps archives.

PRESSURE LEVEL



MEDIA WARS BEGIN

There is already competition beyond the football field. Josh's league podcast with Jim & John gives the Punteliga another source of analysis, opinion and irresponsible speculation.

Unfortunately, they don't always agree with us. The Daily Punt welcomes this diversity of opinion. They're allowed to be wrong.



FIVE QUESTIONS THAT WILL DEFINE YEAR ONE

1 ARE THE CHUGGERS THE TEAM TO BEAT?

Ben's experience combined with an already deep roster has San Diego looking like one of the safest bets in the league. But favorites don't win championships in August.

2 CAN THE JETS' ROOKIE OWNER SHOCK THE LEAGUE?

Ruben has already exceeded expectations. The talent appears real. Now somebody just needs to confiscate his phone whenever George Pickens starts trending.

3 HOW FAR WILL DENVER LOYALTY GO?

Bo Nix is already a Browncock. There will be more Broncos entering future drafts. Michi has draft picks. You see where this is going.

4 WHO OWNS WASHINGTON?

David's Foreskins and Kye's Commando share a city. Neither intends to share the spotlight. The first Washington derby could become one of the league's defining annual fixtures.

5 HOW UGLY CAN OILERS-GAMBLERS GET?

Julian and Kyle have already exchanged shots. The season hasn't started. They haven't played each other. Nobody has lost anything yet. Excellent.

